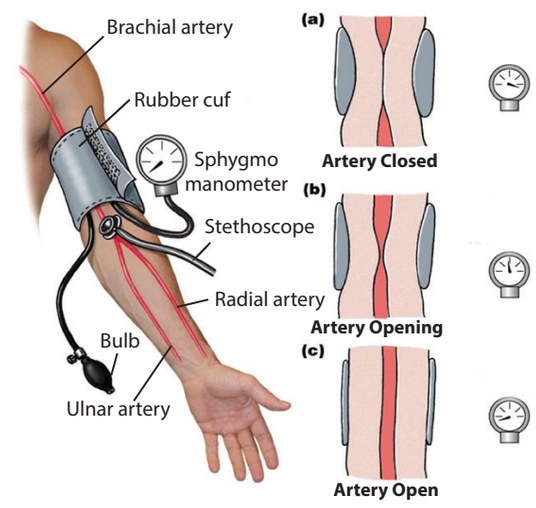
- Do not use the extremity that is injured, diseased, paralyzed, receiving intravenous infusion or when a female patient is with radical mastectomy on the same side.
- When the arm cannot be used to measure the blood pressure, the thigh can be used being a good alternative site.
- Always take the blood pressure reading on the same side and in the same position to maintain consistency.
- Place the site (arm or leg) about the level of heart while taking blood pressure.
- The apparatus should be in working order. The cuff should be of appropriate size (12 – 14 cm for arm and 18 – 20 cm for thigh) and deflated before wrapping around the patient's site.
- While taking blood pressure, certain sounds are heard in sequence. These are called as korotkoff sounds and are described as under.

Tapping: The faint clear sounds that gradually become louder, the first tapping sound may be followed by an absence of sound (auscultator gap) and indicates systolic pressure reading.



Systolic Pressure is the top number. It represents the pressure as your heart contracts to pump blood to the body.

Diastolic Pressure is the bottom number. It represents the pressure between beats, when your heart relaxes.

Murmuring: The low swishing sounds that increase with cuff deflation.

Knocking: The crisp, clear sounds that occur with each heart beat.

Muffling: Abrupt change of sound indicates first diastolic pressure reading

No sounds: The sound disappears and indicates second diastolic pressure reading.When deflating the cuff to take the readings, deflate the cuff to 0. Do not stop in between and start inflating again as this gives a false reading.

Note the variations in blood pressure.

Procedure:

- Explain the procedure to patient. See patient is relaxed and is in a

STUDENT'S ACTIVITY

When you are working the day shift at medical ward. Sally Sims, a 72-year-old female was admitted to your unit with hypertension. What is your plan of assessment?

Nursing-voc_Unit 06.indd 190 22-02-2019 4.45.58 PM